

Joseph Flammia

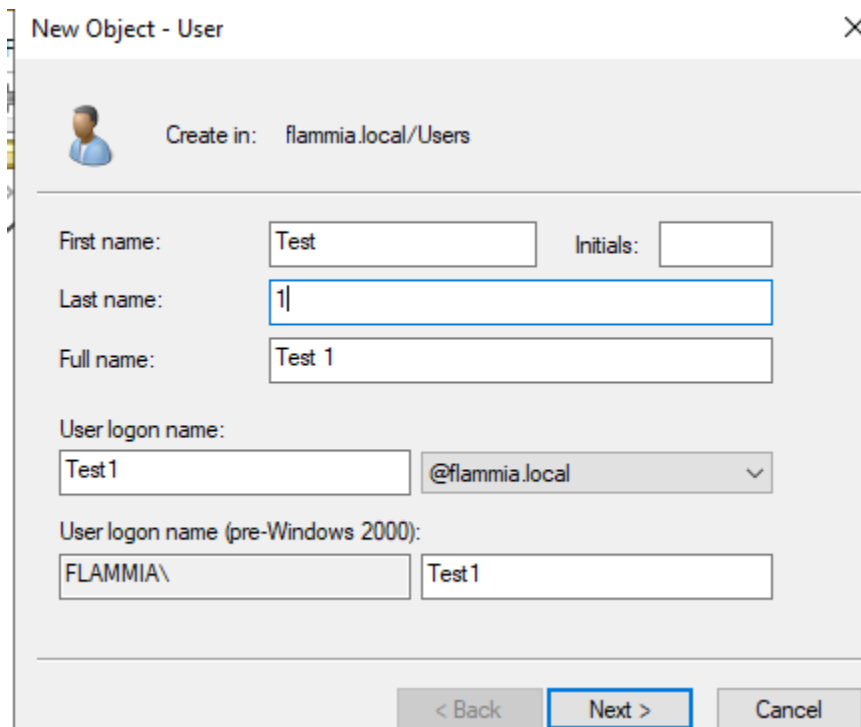
Lab 8

2/24/25

CYB126

Lab 8A:

To start off, we will create a new user in AD's Users and Computers application. As shown below, I created a new user named "Test 1".



The screenshot shows the 'New Object - User' dialog box in the Active Directory Users and Computers application. The dialog is titled 'New Object - User' and has a close button (X) in the top right corner. It features a user icon and the text 'Create in: flammia.local/Users'. The form contains the following fields:

- First name: Test
- Initials: (empty)
- Last name: 1
- Full name: Test 1
- User logon name: Test1
- User logon name (pre-Windows 2000): FLAMMIA\

At the bottom, there are three buttons: '< Back', 'Next >', and 'Cancel'. The 'Next >' button is highlighted with a blue border.

When setting the password, I made it "lake", a simple four-letter word. When trying to confirm my user's creation, I was prompted with an error message. As you can see, the password does not meet the "password policy" because it is too short and does not meet the minimum password length, complexity, and history requirements.



Windows cannot set the password for Test 1 because:
The password does not meet the password policy requirements. Check the minimum password length, password complexity and password history requirements.

OK

Since the policy enforces a complex and longer password, I went back and changed the password from “lake” to “P@ssw0rd”. When I tried to complete the user’s creation, I was met with no errors and was able to successfully create the user.

Active Directory Users and Computers

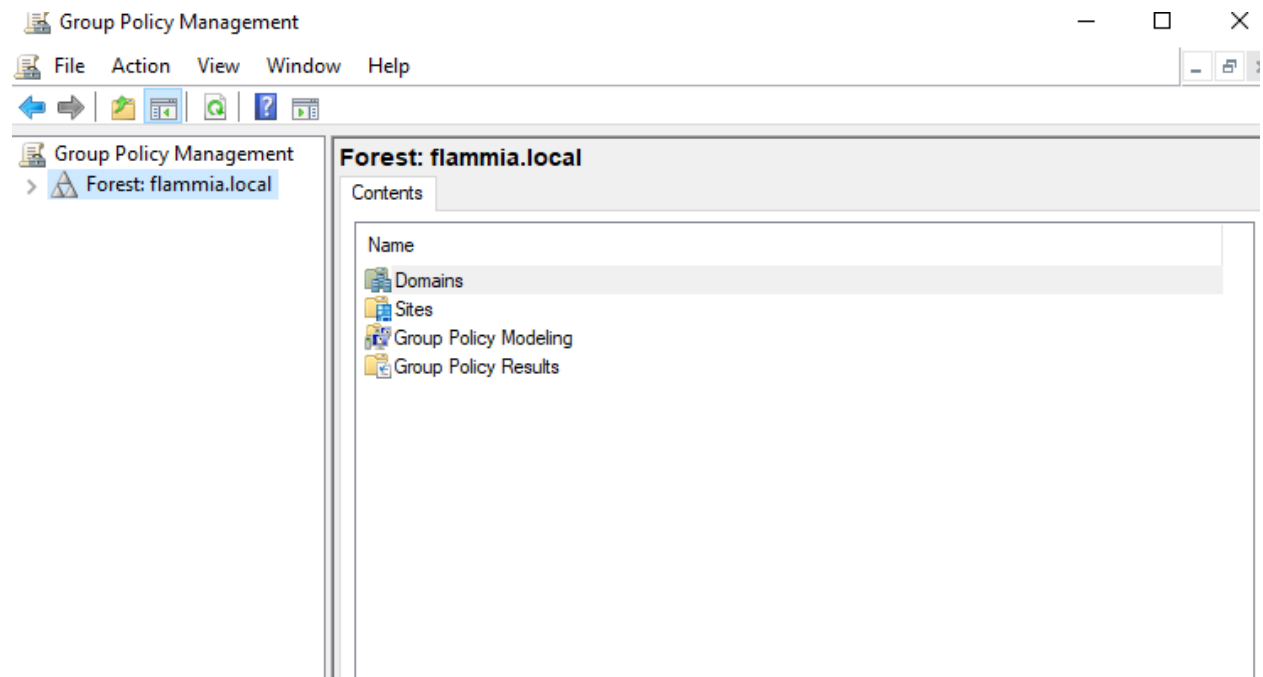
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Active Directory Users and Com

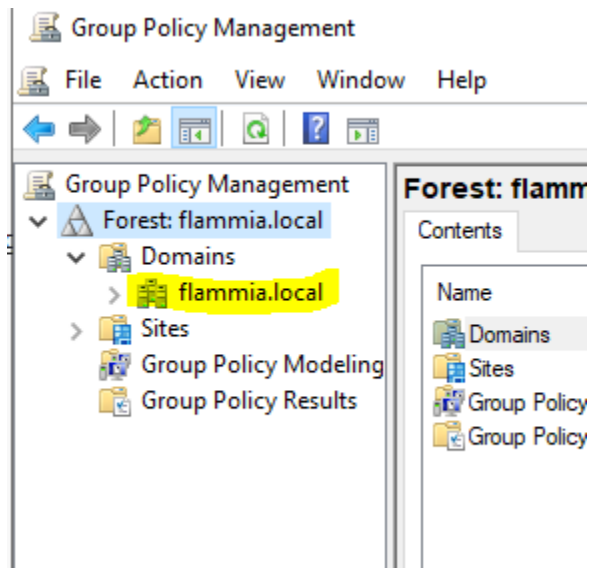
- > Saved Queries
- ▼ flammia.local
 - > Built-in
 - > Computers
 - > Domain Controllers
 - > ForeignSecurityPrincipal...
 - > Managed Service Account...
 - > ROOM16
 - Users

Name	Type	Description
Domain Con...	Security Group...	All domain controllers i...
Domain Gue...	Security Group...	All domain guests
Domain Users	Security Group...	All domain users
Enterprise A...	Security Group...	Designated administrato...
Enterprise K...	Security Group...	Members of this group ...
Enterprise R...	Security Group...	Members of this group ...
flamj95	User	
Group Polic...	Security Group...	Members in this group c...
Guest	User	Built-in account for gue...
Harry Jones	User	
IT	Security Group...	
Jake Finn	User	
Key Admins	Security Group...	Members of this group ...
Protected Us...	Security Group...	Members of this group ...
RAS and IAS ...	Security Group...	Servers in this group can...
Read-only D...	Security Group...	Members of this group ...
Sales	Security Group...	
Schema Ad...	Security Group...	Designated administrato...
Test 1	User	
Thomas Frank	User	

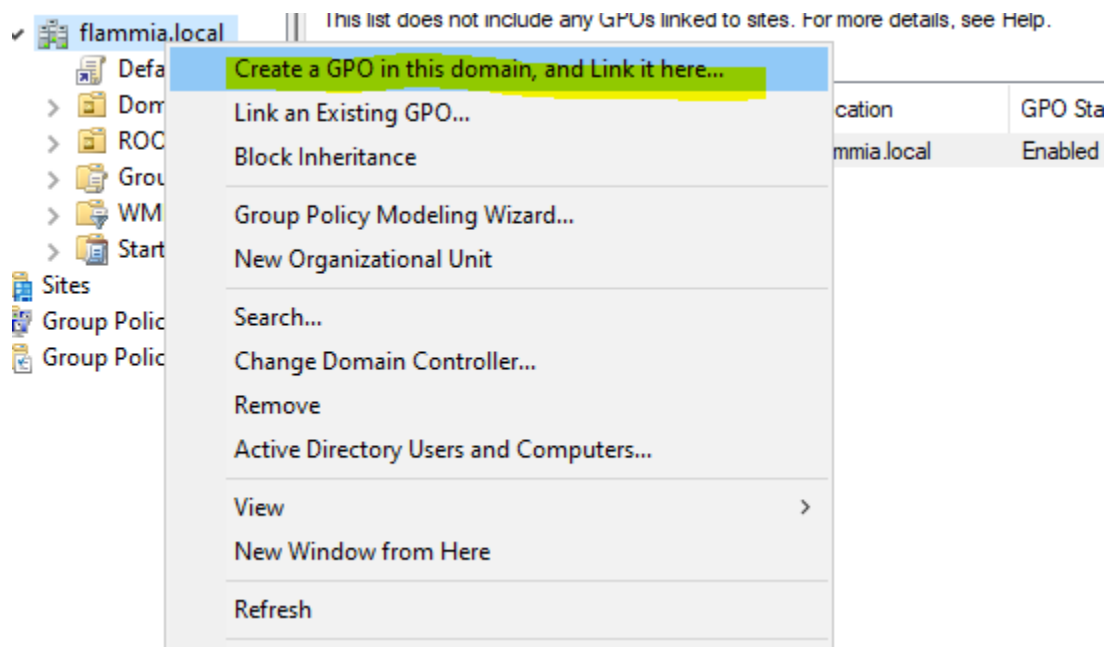
If we wanted to change the policy so that we could use a short, non-complex password, we can do so by navigating to the “Group Policy Management” application on our AD server via the taskbar.



Once opened, we can create new group policies for our domain. On the left-hand side of the application, I clicked the drop-down tabs until I reached the name of my domain, “flammia.local”



From here, we will want to right click on “flammia.local” and then add a new “GPO” to this domain.



From here, we can name the new GPO in a pop-up. Here, I simply named the GPO “Password Policy”.

New GPO

Name:

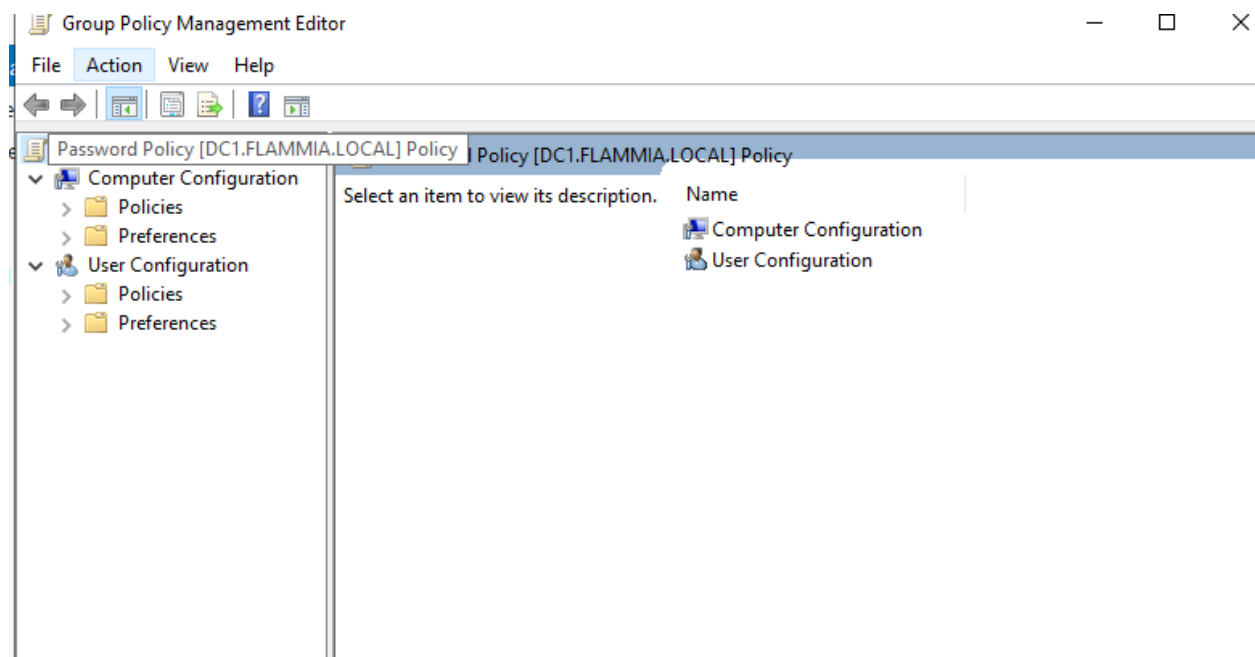
Password Policy

Source Starter GPO:

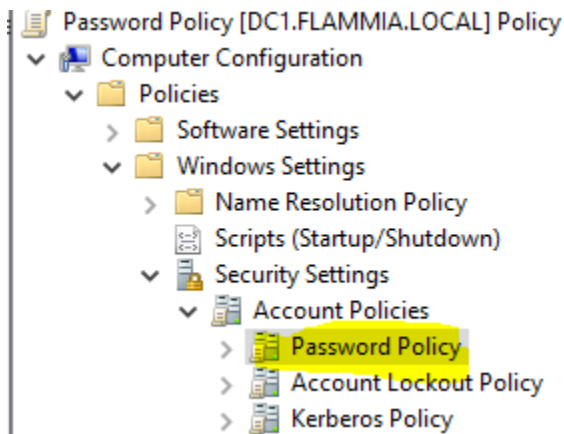
(none)

OK Cancel

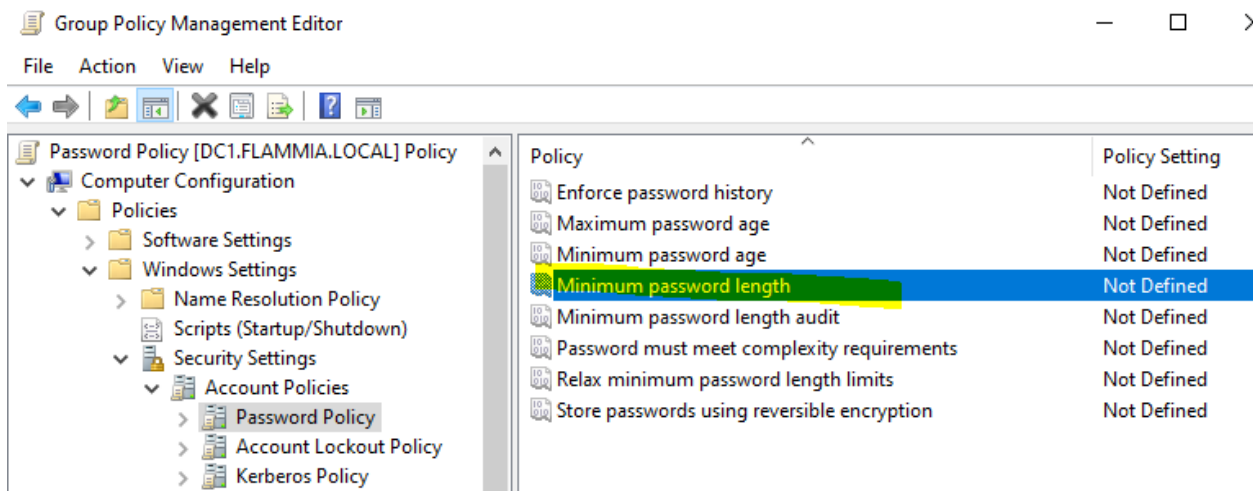
After clicking “OK”, the new policy will be created. From here, simply right click on the policy on the left-hand side, click edit, and we can now start to edit the policy from here.



To change password requirements, we will have to go through several levels. From the action screen, click Computer Configuration, then Policies, then Windows Settings, then Security Settings, then Account Policies, and finally Password Policy.

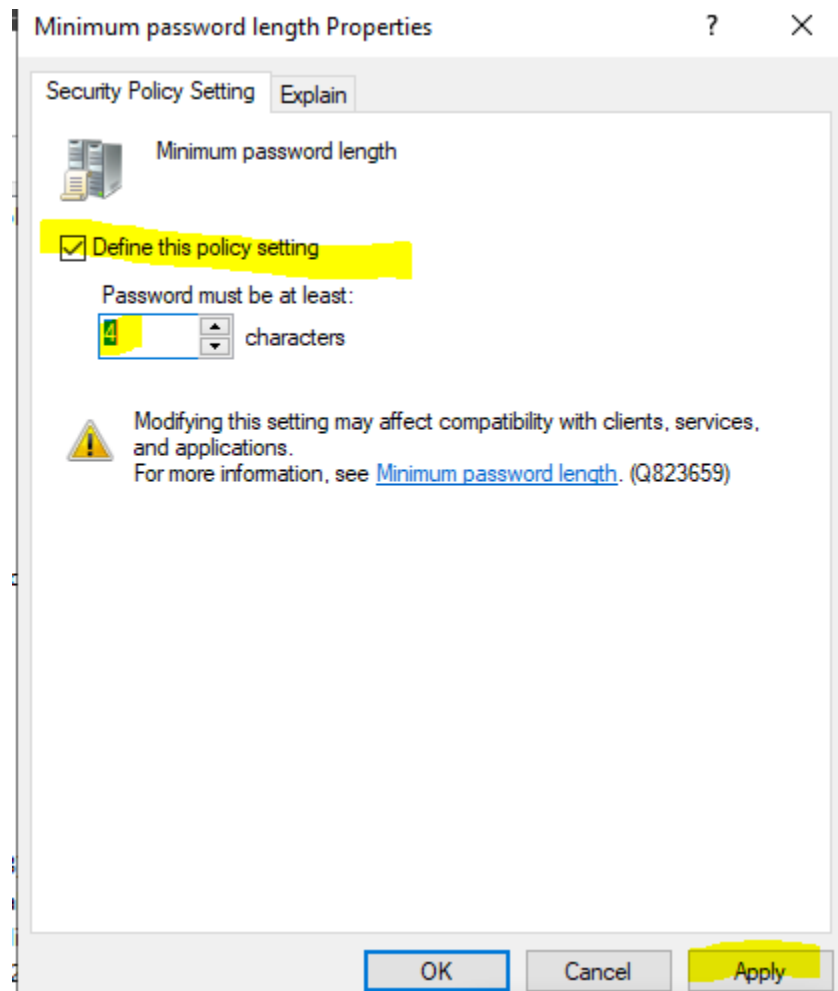


From here, we can see a list of all policies pertaining to password requirements. For now, we will just focus on the “Minimum password length” policy.



To edit this policy, right click on it, hit properties, and then we will be greeted with the policy editor. Make sure to checkmark the “Define this policy setting” to enforce the new

rule. Right below that, we can change the password length requirements. Here, I made it so the password only must have a minimum of 4 characters.



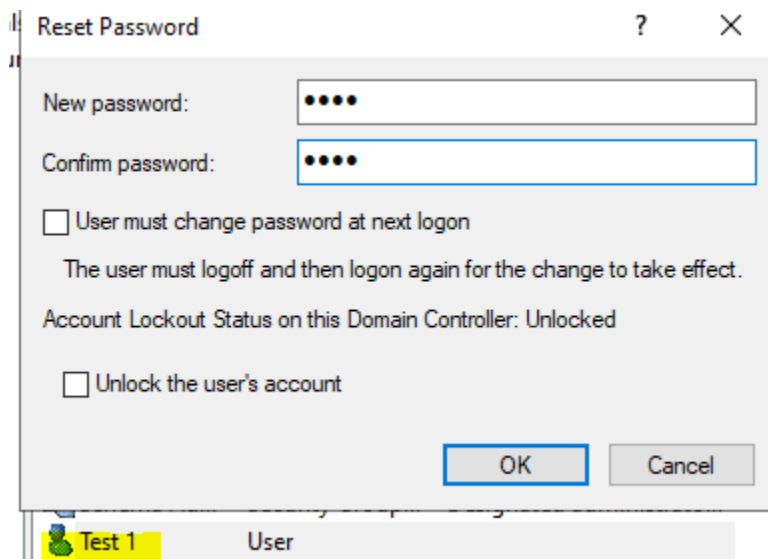
Once done with our configurations, we must hit apply to put our changes into effect.

Before our group policy changes will start working, we need to either restart our system or run command “gpupdate” in the command prompt to force the group policies to update. As pictured below, I entered the command “gpupdate”, and the policy update completed successfully.

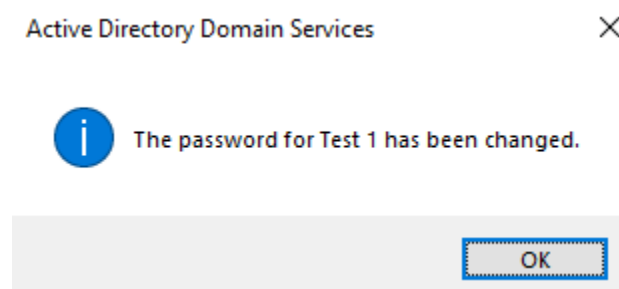
```
C:\Users\flamj95>gpupdate
Updating policy...

Computer Policy update has completed successfully.
User Policy update has completed successfully.
```

Now we can try to change our previously created user’s password to a simple, 4-character password. To do this, head back to the Users and Computers application, find the user, right click on them, and hit “reset password” to change their password.

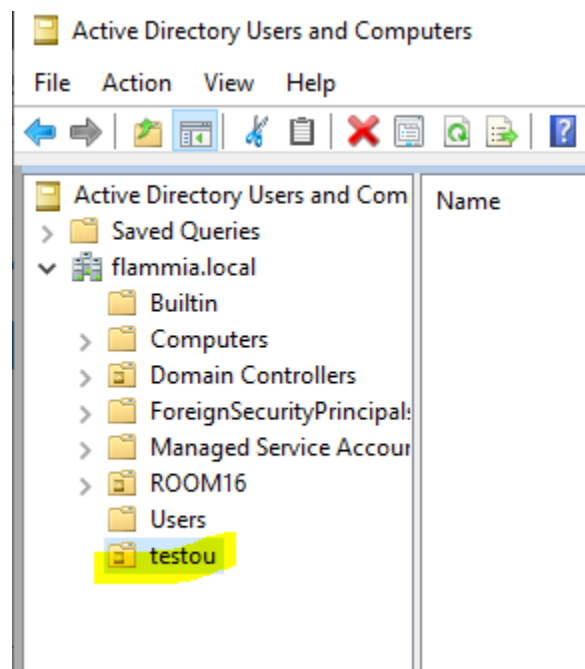


When trying to change the password with the password “lake”, I encountered no issues, and my changes were successful.

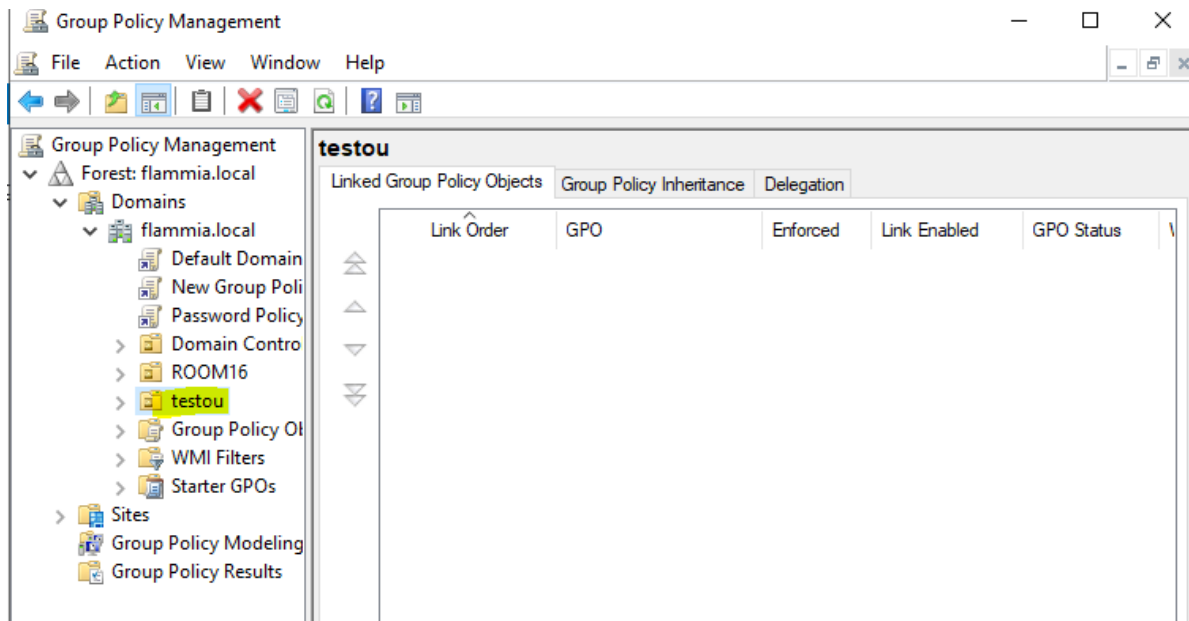


Lab 8B:

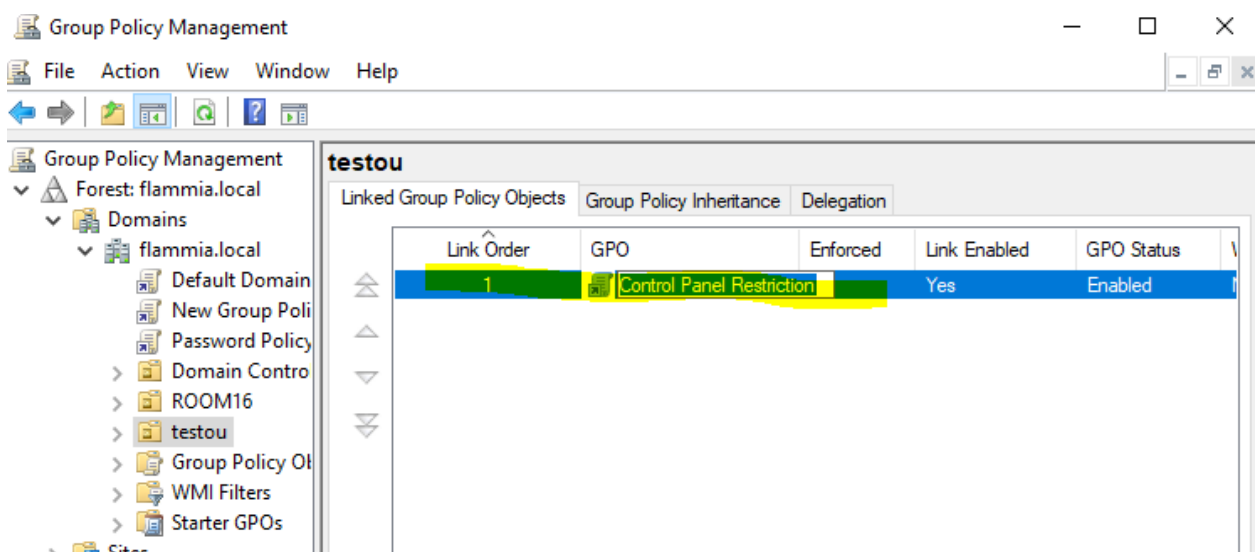
To start off, I created a new OU in my domain called “testou”.



Here, we are going to create a new group policy that prevents users that belong in this OU accessing the control panel. To do this, we must go back to the Group Policy Editor and find our newly created OU.

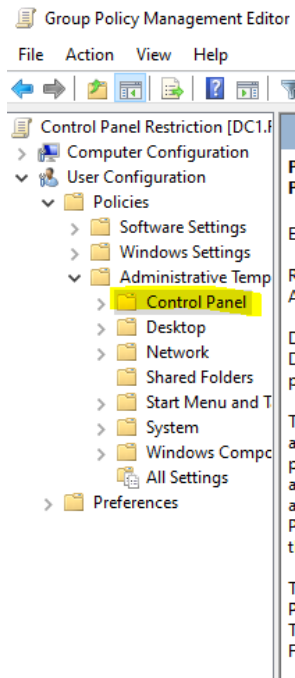


From here, right click on the new OU, hit “Create a new GPO”, and then give the new policy a name to create it. As you can see below, I made the name for the policy “Control Panel Restriction”.

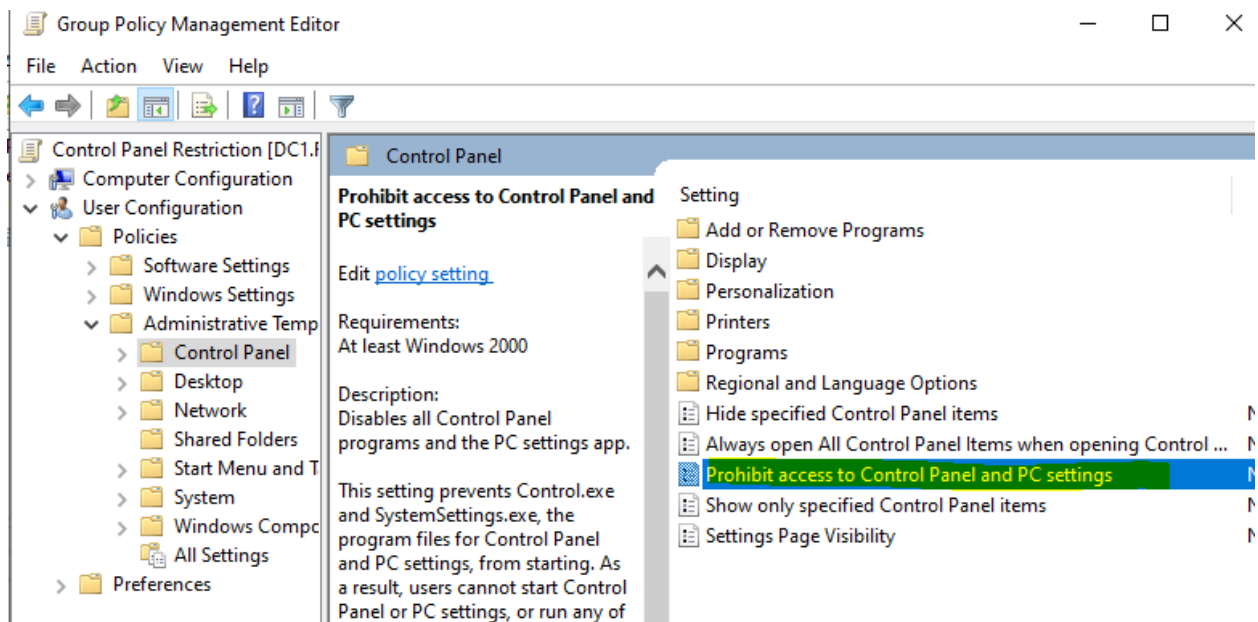


To find the policy list for the control panel, right click on the new policy, and then hit edit.
From here, we will have to click on the following to get to the right level.

Click User Configuration, then Policies, then Administrative Templates, and finally Control Panel.



Once at the correct level, the policy we will want to focus on is “Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings”.



From here, right click on the policy, then click on edit, and from here we can enable the policy for any users in this OU. As shown below, I made sure to click the “enabled” section, and then hit apply to confirm my changes.

Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings

Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings

Previous Setting Next Setting

☐ Not Configured Comment:

☒ Enabled

☐ Disabled

Supported on: At least Windows 2000

Options:

Help:

Disables all Control Panel programs and the PC settings app.

This setting prevents Control.exe and SystemSettings.exe, the program files for Control Panel and PC settings, from starting. As a result, users cannot start Control Panel or PC settings, or run any of their items.

This setting removes Control Panel from:

- The Start screen
- File Explorer

This setting removes PC settings from:

- The Start screen
- Settings charm
- Account picture
- Search results

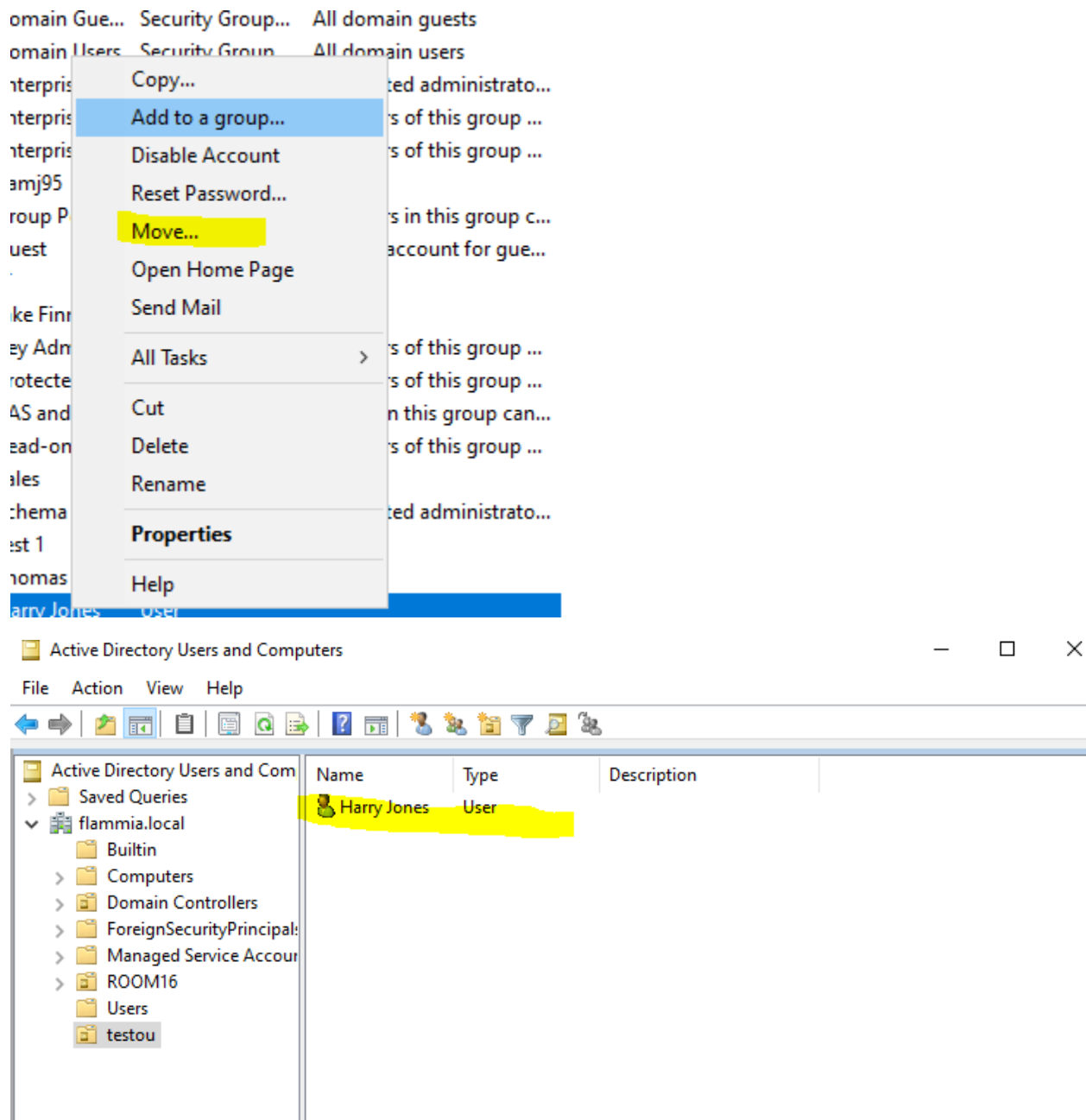
If users try to select a Control Panel item from the Properties item on a context menu, a message appears explaining that a setting prevents the action.

OK Cancel Apply

Once we click apply, all we must do is run the “gpupdate” command in command prompt to force the group policies to update.

To test that our changes were successful, we will log onto our Windows 11 system. Before doing this, we must move one of the users into the “testou” container. As pictured below, I

clicked on the desired user, clicked “move,” and then moved the user into the “testou” OU.



Now moving over to my Windows 11 system, I logged in as “Harry Jones” and attempted to access the control panel. However, I was greeted with this error message.

✖ Restrictions

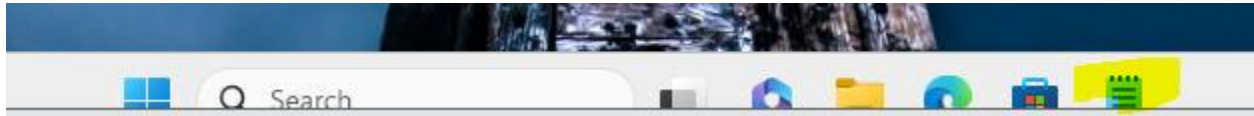


This operation has been cancelled due to restrictions in effect on this computer. Please contact your system administrator.

OK

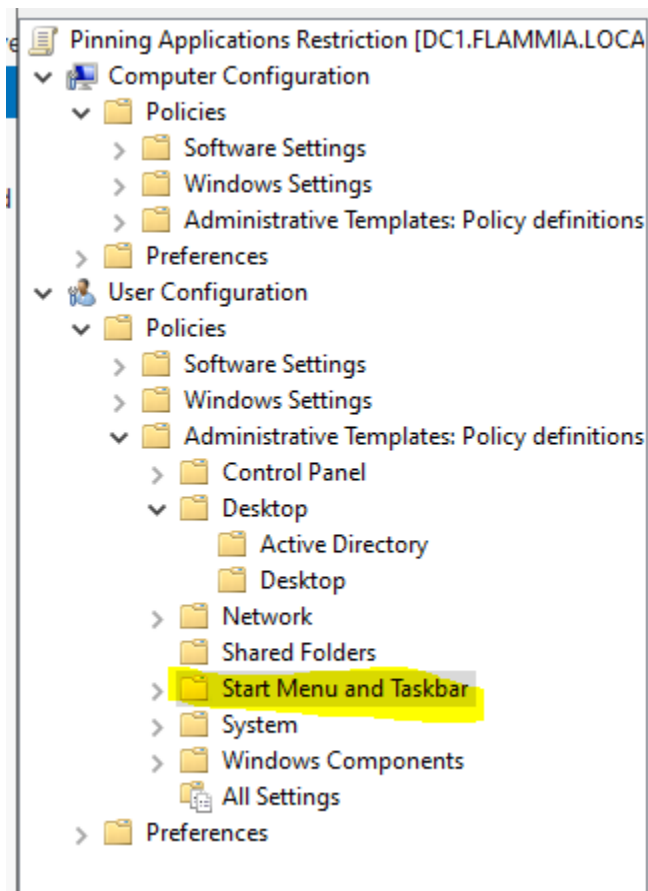
Lab 8C:

On my Windows 11 system, I pinned an application to my taskbar. As shown below, I pinned the notepad application.



Switching back to my AD server, I opened the Group Policy editor and made a new policy called “Pinning Applications Restriction”. From here I navigated through the following levels:

Click User Configuration, then Policies, then Administrative Templates, and lastly “Start Menu and Taskbar”



The policy we will be focusing on here is “Do not allow pinning programs to the Taskbar”.

Group Policy Management Editor

File Action View Help

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Pinning Applications Restriction [DC1.FLA]

- Computer Configuration
 - Policies
 - Software Settings
 - Windows Settings
 - Administrative Templates: Policies
 - Preferences
- User Configuration
 - Policies
 - Software Settings
 - Windows Settings
 - Administrative Templates: Policies
 - Control Panel
 - Desktop
 - Active Directory
 - Desktop
 - Network
 - Shared Folders
 - Start Menu and Taskbar
 - System
 - Windows Components
 - All Settings

Start Menu and Taskbar

Do not allow pinning programs to the Taskbar

Edit [policy setting](#)

Requirements:
At least Windows Server 2008 R2 or Windows 7

Description:
This policy setting allows you to control pinning programs to the Taskbar.

If you enable this policy setting, users cannot change the programs currently pinned to the Taskbar. If any programs are already pinned to the Taskbar, these programs continue to show in the Taskbar. However, users cannot unpin these programs already pinned to the Taskbar, and they cannot pin new programs to

Setting

- Show or hide "Most used" list from Start menu
- Show "Run as different user" command on Start
- Add the Run command to the Start Menu
- Show Start on the display the user is using when they
- Remove Logoff on the Start Menu
- Pin Apps to Start when installed
- Show additional calendar
- Remove Notifications and Action Center
- Disable showing balloon notifications as toasts.
- Remove the Security and Maintenance icon
- Remove the Meet Now icon
- Remove the networking icon
- Remove the battery meter
- Remove the volume control icon
- Turn off feature advertisement balloon notifications
- Do not allow pinning Store app to the Taskbar
- Do not allow pinning items in Jump Lists
- Do not allow pinning programs to the Taskbar**

Using the same process as before, right click on the policy, click edit, and then enable the policy and apply your changes.

The screenshot shows the Windows Group Policy Editor window for the policy "Do not allow pinning programs to the Taskbar". The policy is currently set to "Enabled", which is highlighted with a yellow background. The "Comment" field is empty. The "Supported on" field shows "At least Windows Server 2008 R2 or Windows 7". The "Options" and "Help" sections are visible at the bottom. The "Help" section contains the following text:

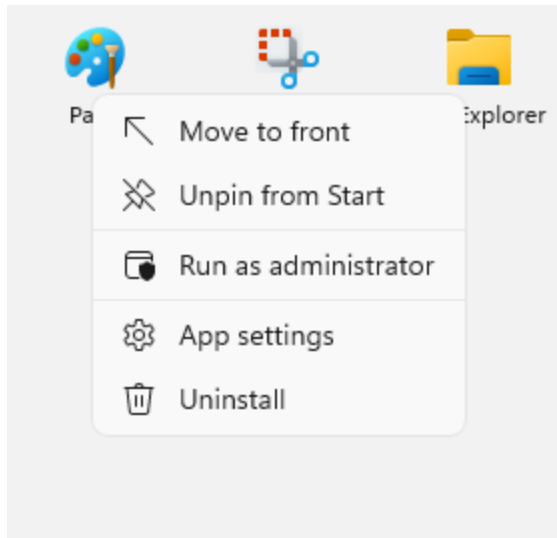
This policy setting allows you to control pinning programs to the Taskbar.

If you enable this policy setting, users cannot change the programs currently pinned to the Taskbar. If any programs are already pinned to the Taskbar, these programs continue to show in the Taskbar. However, users cannot unpin these programs already pinned to the Taskbar, and they cannot pin new programs to the Taskbar.

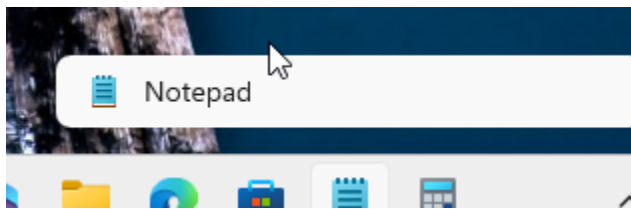
If you disable or do not configure this policy setting, users can change the programs currently pinned to the Taskbar.

Just like in the previous steps, we must run the command “gpupdate” for our policies to take effect. Once the command is complete, we can now test our configurations.

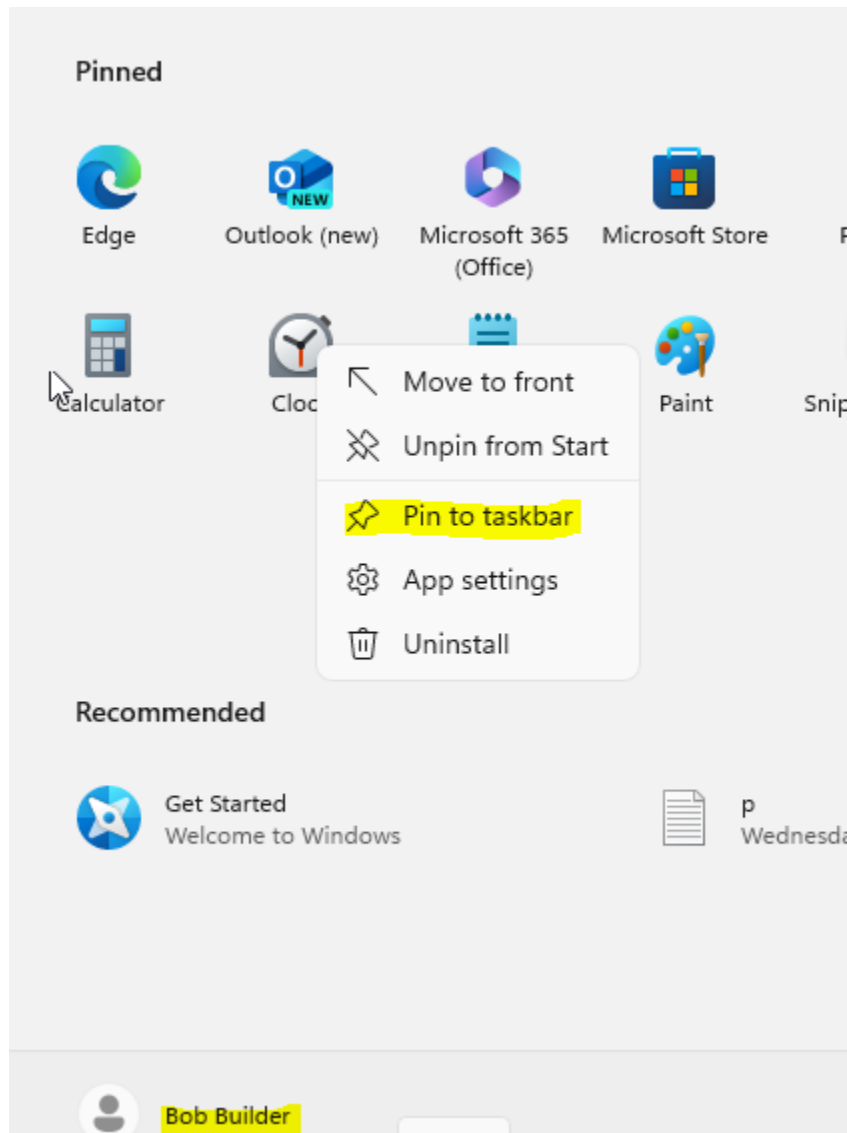
Switching back to the Windows 11 VM, when trying to pin a program to the taskbar, there is no option that will let you do this.



Furthermore, I am unable to unpin a program from the taskbar. As shown below, when right clicking the “notepad” application, no options can unpin the application.



When compared to a user not in the OU, we can pin applications to the taskbar easily. Here, I logged in with the user “Bob Builder”, a user that is not in the OU.



Additionally, we are also given the option to unpin applications from the taskbar.

